ethnic group inside what are effectively prison camps. The threat of legal action, not on the basis of future actions, but in terms of what has already been done, would be a powerful statement that these individuals are not immune from being held accountable for their actions. In this respect, it is essential that the ICC calls for the prosecution of named Rakhine leaders.

Domestic pressure

Finally, groups and individuals are active in Myanmar who reject the logic and claims of the extremists. While the regime fears a US-inspired 'colour revolution',[44] acknowledging the existence of these dissenting groups is important. Sometimes such challenges will happen over a specific issue for reasons not immediately connected with the Rohingyas. For example, the opposition of many Buddhist women's groups to the recent marriage bill was framed in terms of women's rights and freedom, rather than particularly in terms of the clear attempt to break some of the few remaining links between Myanmar's Muslim minorities and the rest of the population. In consequence, these activist groups forced Aung San Suu Kyi to oppose the legislation limiting the rights of Buddhists and Muslims to marry—on the grounds that this was a direct attack on women's rights.[45] This in turn has led to the Buddhist and Rakhine extremists claiming that the NLD is now a pro-Muslim party.

While it is clear that both the USDP and the NLD have links to the Buddhist extremists, there is evidence that the regime, the USDP and the NLD sometimes feel they are being pushed too far by the MaBaTha, the 969 Movement and the Rakhine ethnic extremists. Sometimes this is due to a fear of provoking an international response, but at other times it is connected with simple human decency. During the worst of this spring's refugee crisis, Nyam Min, an NLD spokesman, published a bold and strongly-worded statement: 'If they are not accepted (as citizens), they cannot just be sent onto rivers. Can't be pushed out to sea. They are humans. I just see them as humans who are entitled to human rights'.[46] Given the studied ambiguity, if not actual indifference, of most NLD comments about the Rohingyas, this is remarkable. Subsequent events, in terms of voter registration and candidate selection for the elections,[47] suggest this is not indicative of a fundamental shift. However, at least some